MyProCoach™

TRAINING PLAN

Marathon Running

RUNNING	BEGINNER	12 WEEKS

Welcome

As an athlete and a parent I know how challenging it can be to train effectively for events like triathlons, marathons or cycling events. I have over 20 years of experience helping amateur athletes surpass their goals, while still making sure they have quality time available for family, friends and career.

To help you train effectively, I have decided to offer a subset of our extremely popular plans for free. Usually, our plans include email coach access, personal intensity zones and advanced tracking software. But these plans provide the basics for free to give you a taste.

It would mean the world to me if you tried a 1-month free trial of Unlimited Athlete, my low-cost coaching program, but for now, feel free to get used to my style of training. Please use and share this plan as much as you like.

FAQS

Who is the plan suitable for?

This training plan is suitable for Beginner or time-limited runners, aiming to get in peak shape for a marathon event.

With just 12 weeks to go until event-day, this plan assumes you are currently able to run for up to 1hr 20mins. The plan builds up to race day, and helps improve your fitness and confidence.

People who follow a training plan have been shown to be twice as likely to succeed in reaching their goal.

How much training is involved?

Average weekly training hours are 4:10 with the biggest week at 5:28 hours. This includes 3 to 4 runs and a 45 minute strength and conditioning session.

There is usually 1 workout per day, with 2 or 3 days off each week.

Every fourth week is an active recovery week, with less training, to help your body recover and adapt.

How to get started

Do your best to follow the workouts below, ideally in their given order.

To help you train at the right levels, we use five training zones, based on feel or heart rate.

If you use heart rate, we have a calculator that can create your training zones:

www.myprocoach.net/hr-zones

TRAINING ZONES

	Intensity Description	% of Your Max Heart Rate
Z1	Easy (Recovery)	♥ 68-73%
Z2	Steady (Endurance)	♥ 73-80%
Z3	Moderately Hard (Tempo)	♥ 80-87%
Z4	Hard (Threshold)	♥ 87-93%
Z5	Very Hard (VO2 Max)	♥ 93-100%

GLOSSARY

Key	Description
Z1	Training Zone 1
Z2	Training Zone 2
Z3	Training Zone 3
Z4	Training Zone 4
Z5	Training Zone 5

Week 1

Base Phase 1: 3 hrs 57 mins

Phil's tip

This plan includes a strength and conditioning workout each week.
Download your strength and conditioning PDF: https://bit.ly/RunSandC

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1	41 mins		35 mins	45 mins	36 mins 30 secs		1 hr 20 mins
	Tempo Run	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Strength Endurance	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
	Hard/Threshold		Steady/Endurance	Adaptation Phase	V. Hard/VO2 Max		Steady/Endurance
	Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2. Main Set: 2 x (10 mins in low Z4 + 3 min recoveries in Z1). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2. The intensity of these runs is at, or near to your 1-hour race effort.	Allows for recovery whilst promoting adaptation to previous training stresses. Helps you get faster and keep injuries at bay.	All in low to mid Z2. These runs are to be done slowly. They will gradually build your endurance and increase your efficiency. If you do them faster, you'll increase your injury risk for no real benefit.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips.	Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z4 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 5 x (90 secs in low Z5 up a hill + 2 min recoveries in Z1-Z2). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2. The gradient should be 3 to 6%.		Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2. This is your long run and will gradually increase in duration. If you need to include some walking sections in these runs, in order to keep your heart rate down, that's fine.
SESSION 2							

Week 2

Base Phase 1: 4 hrs 07 mins

Phil's tip

When you're exercising for longer than about 70-80 minutes you need to consume carbohydrate during your workouts to stop your energy levels from dropping.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		42 mins	40 mins	45 mins	30 mins		1 hr 30 mins
	Recovery Day	Tempo Run	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Strength Endurance	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
		Hard/Threshold	Steady/Endurance	Adaptation Phase	V. Hard/VO2 Max		Steady/Endurance
		Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2 to Z3. Main Set: 3 x (7 mins in low Z4 + 2 min recoveries in Z1). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2. The intensity of these runs is at, or near to your 1-hour race effort.	All in low to mid Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Warm Up: 7 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z4 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 4 x (90 secs in low Z5 up a hill + 2 min recoveries in Z1-Z2). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2. The gradient should be 3 to 6%.		Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 3

Base Phase 1: 4 hrs 18 mins

Phil's tip

During your Zone 2 workouts, you should theoretically feel able to chat throughout. If not, slow down.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		45 mins	45 mins	45 mins	33 mins		1 hr 40 mins
	Recovery Day	Tempo Run	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Strength Endurance	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
		Hard/Threshold	Steady/Endurance	Endurance Phase	V. Hard/VO2 Max		Steady/Endurance
		Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2. Main Set: 9 mins in low Z4 + 2 mins recovery in Z1, 8 mins in low Z4 + 2 mins recovery in Z1, 7 mins in low Z4 + 2 mins recovery in Z1. Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Warm Up: 6 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z4 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 6 x (60 secs in low Z5 up a hill + 2 min recoveries in Z1-Z2). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2.		Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 4

Active Recovery Week: 2 hrs 53 mins

Phil's tip

In my training plans, every 4th week is an active recovery week. This gives your body a chance to recover and adapt.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		30 mins	31 mins		27 mins	45 mins	40 mins
	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Tempo Run	Recovery Day	Speed Run	Strength Endurance	Aerobic Endurance
		Steady/Endurance	Hard/Threshold		V. Hard/VO2 Max	Endurance Phase	Steady/Endurance
	It's vital to make the most of these recovery weeks. You need to fully recover and start each new training phase feeling fresh and eager to train hard. There is enough training during the recovery weeks so that you won't lose fitness.	All in low to mid Z2.	Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z4 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 12 mins in low Z4. Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2.		Warm Up: 6 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z4 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 4 x (2 mins in Z5 + 60 secs in Z1). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Easy or steady run all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 5

Build Phase 1: 4 hrs 48 mins

Phil's tip

Don't feel you need to do all your workouts alone. If you enjoy doing club or group workouts, you can still incorporate these into your training plan.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		45 mins	40 mins	45 mins	48 mins		1 hr 50 mins
	Recovery Day	Progression Run	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Marathon Pace Efforts	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
		Hard/Threshold	Steady/Endurance	Endurance Phase	Steady/Endurance		Steady/Endurance
		Main Set: 10 mins in low Z2, 10 mins in upper Z2, 5 mins in low Z3, 5 mins in upper Z3, 5 mins in low Z4, 5 mins in mid Z4. Warm Down: 5 mins in low Z2. This tough workout will improve your running stamina and teach the body and mind to stay strong throughout your race.	All in low to mid Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2. Main Set: 10, 9, 8 mins all in high Z2 + 2 min recoveries in Z1. Warm Down: 5 mins in low Z2. This run is designed to simulate race day, including efforts at race pace with short recoveries		Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 6

Build Phase 1: 5 hrs 10 mins

Phil's tip

Find out more about your running form in my article:
What is Proper Running Form? https://bit.ly/MPCRunForm

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		50 mins	40 mins	45 mins	55 mins		2 hrs
	Recovery Day	Progression Run	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Marathon Pace Efforts	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
		Hard/Threshold	Steady/Endurance	Endurance Phase	Steady/Endurance		Steady/Endurance
		Main Set: 10 mins in low Z2, 5 mins in upper Z2, 10 mins in low Z3, 5 mins in upper Z3, 5 mins in low Z4, 5 mins in mid Z4. Warm Down: 10 mins in low Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2. Main Set: 10, 9, 8, 7 mins all in high Z2 + 90 sec recoveries in Z1. Warm Down: 5 mins in low Z2.		With Race Paced Finish: Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2. Do the last 10 minutes at high Z2. This run will help you stay strong when the race feels the toughest. Doing this at the end of your long run in training will give you confidence to push for the finish on race day.
SESSION 2							

Week 7

Build Phase 1: 5 hrs 28 mins

Phil's tip

Consistency is the golden ticket. Think of each completed workout as another jelly bean in the jar. When the jar is full, you're in peak race shape.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		1 hr	40 mins	45 mins	53 mins		2 hr 10 mins
	Recovery Day	Progression Run	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Marathon Pace Efforts	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
		Hard/Threshold	Steady/Endurance	Endurance Phase	Steady/Endurance		Steady/Endurance
		Main Set: 10 mins in low Z2, 10 mins in upper Z2, 10 mins in low Z3, 10 mins in upper Z3, 5 mins in low Z4, 5 mins in mid Z4. Warm Down: 10 mins in low Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2. Main Set: 10, 9, 8, 7 mins all in high Z2 + 60 sec recoveries in Z1. Warm Down: 5 mins in low Z2.		With Race Paced Finish: Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2. Do the last 15 minutes at high Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 8

Active Recovery Week: 3 hrs 08 mins

Phil's tip

Get my monthly newsletter with training tips straight to your inbox.
https://www.myprocoach.net/blog/

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		30 mins	42 mins		31 mins	45 mins	40 mins
	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Tempo Run	Recovery Day	Speed Run	Strength and Conditioning	Aerobic Endurance
		Steady/Endurance	Hard/Threshold		V. Hard/VO2 Max	Strength Phase	Steady/Endurance
		All in low to mid Z2.	Warm Up: 15 mins in Z2 to Z3. Main Set: 2 x (10 mins in low Z4 + 2 min recovery in Z1). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2.		Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z4 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 4 x (2 mins in Z5 + 60 secs in Z1). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Easy or steady run all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 9

Peak Phase 1: 5 hrs 23 mins

Phil's tip

Want to export your workouts to your devices and follow them as you train? Get this and more, with my low-cost coaching program. Try 1-month free, today!
https://bit.ly/MPConemonthfree

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		38 mins	60 mins	45 mins	40 mins		2 hrs 20 mins
	Recovery Day	Speed Run	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Aerobic Endurance	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
		V. Hard/VO2 Max	Steady/Endurance	Strength Phase	Steady/Endurance		Steady/Endurance
		Warm Up: 8 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z5 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 7 x (60 secs in upper Z5 + 2 min recoveries in Z1). Warm Down: 5 mins in low Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	All in low to mid Z2. Ideally on a hilly route.		With Race Paced Finish: Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2. Do the last 15 mins at high Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 10

Peak Phase 1: 5 hrs 15 mins

Phil's tip

Want rapid email access to your own coach? Why not try my low-cost coaching program for 1-month free?
https://bit.ly/MPConemonthfree

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		25 mins	60 mins	45 mins	35 mins		2 hr 30 mins
	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Speed Run	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
		Steady/Endurance	Steady/Endurance	Strength Phase	V. Hard/VO2 Max		Steady/Endurance
		All in low to mid Z2.	All in low to mid Z2. Ideally on a hilly route.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Warm Up: 7 mins in Z2, 5 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z5 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 4 x (90 secs in upper Z5 with 3 min recoveries in Z1 to Z2). Warm Down: 5 mins in low Z2.		Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 11

Peak Phase 1: 3 hrs 52 mins

Phil's tip

Pacing is a key factor for success in racing.
How to Pace Your Marathon Race: https://bit.ly/PacingYourMarathon

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1			60 mins	45 mins	37 mins		1 hr 30 mins
	Recovery Day	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Speed Run	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
			Steady/Endurance	Strength Phase	V. Hard/VO2 Max		Steady/Endurance
			All in low to mid Z2. Ideally on a hilly route.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Warm Up: 8 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z5 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 3 x (2 mins in upper Z5 + 3 min recoveries in Z1 to Z2). Warm Down: 10 mins in low Z2.		With Race Paced Finish: Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2. Do the last 15 mins at high Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 12

Race Taper Week: 1 hrs 30 mins

Phil's tip

Good luck for your event! We'd love to hear about your training journey and race day experience, via our Instagram, Facebook or Reviews pages.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		30 mins	30 mins		30 mins		Marathon
	Recovery Day	Taper Week Run	Taper Week Run	Recovery Day	Taper Week Run	Recovery Day	Race Day
		Steady/Endurance	Hard/Threshold		Steady/Endurance		
	This week you will maintain your fitness and eliminate any traces of fatigue. It's a good time to double check your race day logistics and strategies. If your race is on Saturday, move your Friday run to Thursday and take Friday as a rest day.	All in low to mid Z2.	Warm Up: 15 mins in Z2. Main Set: 3 x (60 secs in low Z4 + 2 mins in Z2). Warm Down. 6 mins in Z2.		All in low to mid Z2. If your race is on Saturday, move today's run to Thursday and take today as a rest day.		Good Luck!
SESSION 2							

Reviews

Perfect Plan!

Fantastic training plan from MyProCoach to lead to my first full-distance IRONMAN finish at Arizona in 2022. During the plan, I improved in all three disciplines and PR'd an IRONMAN 70.3 tuneup race by 11 min.

I'm an Unlimited Athlete and love having coach access & a premium membership with TrainingPeaks.

Josh Murphy
23 / 01 / 2023

It really works- trust the plan!

I exceeded my goal of not only finishing but well under my ideal goal. I 100% attribute this to Phil Mosley's 20-week 70.3 plan. I stuck to the plan and I'm beyond ecstatic to say I completed the IRONMAN 70.3 Puerto Rico!

The training truly changed my life and changed the way I think about things I'm able to do now.

I'm forever grateful.

Melissa Marston
21 / 03 / 2023

Love my Unlimited Athlete plan!

I've trained for two years with my Unlimited plan. The best part is that I can request my training plan at any moment!

I did IRONMAN Florida 70.3 last weekend, I'm feeling great and really happy with my result.

I totally recommend MyProCoach!

Ana Maria Pinzon Chatelain
16 / 12 / 2022

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1

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